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THE WHITE HOUSE

Office of the Press Secretary,
(Reykjavik, Iceland)

October 12, 1986

PRESS BRIEFING
BY
SECRETARY OF STATE GEORGE P. SHULTS

White House Press Briefing Center
Lofkladdir Hotel
Reykjavik, Iceland

7:30 P.M. (L)

SECRETARY SHULTS: I've just spent two full, intensive days watching the President of the United States engage with the General Secretary of the Soviet Union over the full range of issues that we are concerned about together. The President's performance was magnificent and I have never been so proud of my President as I have been in these sessions and, particularly, this afternoon.

During the course of these two days, extremely important potential agreements were reached to reduce, in the first instance, strategic arms in half; to deal effectively with intermediate range missiles. Although we didn't finally have the opportunity to come to grips with it, probably to work out something satisfactory about nuclear testing, a satisfactory manner of addressing regional issues, humanitarian concerns and a variety of bilateral matters and a tremendous amount of headway in the issues in space and defense involving the AMM Treaty.

Throughout all of this, the President was constructive, in reaching out and using his creativity and ingenuity to find those very sweeping and substantial and important agreements. It has been clear for a long time and it was certainly clear today and, particularly this afternoon, the importance the Soviet leader attaches to the Strategic Defense Initiative and I think it was quite apparent that at least a key reason why it was possible to reach such sweeping potential agreements was the very fact of Gorbachev's vigorous presence.

In seeking to deal with these issues, the President was ready to agree to a 10-year period of non-withdrawal from the AMM Treaty, a period during which the United States would do research, development and testing which is permitted by the AMM Treaty and, of course, after which we would be permitted to deploy, if we chose. However, as the agreement that might have been said, during this 10-year period, in effect, all offensive strategic arms and ballistic missiles would be eliminated so that at the end of the period the deployment of strategic defense would be substantially altered in what was needed and would be in the nature of an insurance policy; insurance against cheating, insurance against somebody getting hold of these weapons, so it would maintain an effective shield for the United States, for our allies, for the free world.

As we came more and more down to the final stages it became more and more clear that the Soviet Union's objective was effectively to kill off the SDI program. And to do so by seeking a change, described by them as strengthening, but a change in the AMM Treaty that would so constrain research permitted under it that the program would not be able to proceed at all forcefully. The President, hard as he had worked for this extraordinary range and importance of agreements, simply would not turn away from the basic security interests of the United States, our allies and the free world by abandoning this potential defense program. He had to bear in mind, and did bear in mind, that not only is the existence of the Strategic Defense program a key reason why we were able potentially

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to reach these agreements, but undoubtedly its continued existence and potential would be the kind of progress you need in the picture to insure yourself that the agreements reached would be effectively carried out.

And in the end, with great reluctance, the President, having worked so hard, creatively and constructively for three potentially tremendous achievements, simply had to refuse to compromise the security of the U.S., of our allies and freedom by abandoning the shield that has held in front of freedom.

So, in the end, we are deeply disappointed at this outcome, although I think it is important to recognize how effectively and constructively and hard the President worked and how much he achieved potentially -- how ready he was to go absolutely the last -- not just the last mile but, as you can see from what I've told you, quite a long distance to try to bring into being these potentially very significant agreements. But he could not allow the essential ingredient to be destroyed in the process and would not do so.

Questions.

Q So, you said you were not able to succeed on SDI. Did you succeed on any arms agreement?

SECRETARY SHULTS: Everything that was discussed here was discussed to a degree, you might say, in relation to the other parts, although, obviously, many of the things that we're doing go on and of course we will return to Geneva, as I assume they will, and the things that were talked about here, I presume, will be seen in the Geneva talks and in the other talks where we meet with the Soviet Union. And we will continue to strive in every way we can to have a constructive relationship and one that is able to resolve these problems. But we will never do so at the expense of the security of the United States and our allies.

Q Mr. Secretary, what is the status --

Q Mr. Secretary, could you say just to be clear that you had within your grasp the possibility of eliminating all offensive missiles within a 10-year period if there had been that ultimate, final concession by the President on SDI? Is that correct?

SECRETARY SHULTS: That is not the way I think we must think about it because while we had set out many sweeping and potentially very significant things, if they only came to pass as a result of scuttling the SDI program, then you had to ask yourself if they would really come to pass afterward after the SDI program was gone. So they were there potentially, and I think, myself, for the Soviet Union to try to change the ABM Treaty in a way that would very sharply curtail the research that could be done under it was perhaps an indication of where they're headed.

Q Mr. Secretary, do you have a date? Did General Secretary Gorbachev agree to a date to come to the U.S. for a full-scale summit?

SECRETARY SHULTS: No, and there was very little discussion of a full-scale summit. Of course, it was mentioned particularly in the first day and I hope at some point he comes to the U.S. But we ended, of course, having worked so hard and gotten so far, in the deep disappointment at discovering that in the end a change in the ABM Treaty that would have made effective research very, very difficult was a price and, obviously, the kind of price that if you cashed you might wind up losing everything else you had achieved.

Q Mr. Secretary?

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Q Well, they're certainly more
A but it's hard to for me to assess that question
Q because I've been involved in this two days, and we all had
A high hopes and we came very close to realizing them and that's
A kind of a tough moment. But the meetings show that the two
A sides are together and these two leaders at least can engage
A on essentially on important matters. Whether they'll be able to do
A at some time in the future remains to be seen. But in the
A meantime, we will continue in every way we can to pursue our
A four-point agenda, and to advance these causes as best we can and try
A to have a constructive relationship.

1) ЧЕ, СЕКРЕТНО?

Q Mr. Secretary, did the Soviets --

RE. RECOVERY

Q Mr. Secretary, did the Soviets mislead you about what was possible at this summit? Did they come here in good faith?

SECRETARY SHULTS: I'm not going to comment on people's good faith. We came in good faith and, certainly, they engaged with us in a very intensive process. They obviously, made quite a wide variety of important proposals and in the end, however, on the absolute key, they wanted to make a change that I think you'd have to say was predictably not possible for us. But I wouldn't say they came here not in good faith, because they worked at this very hard."

Q: Mr. Secretary?

Q: Mr. Secretary?

Q: HK. BGC9455Y?

SECRETARY SMULLEN: — In the back.

1) Mr. Secretary?

Q Could you describe the change that they sought, sir?

SECRETARY BRUTS: The change by the ABM Treaty was only that we would confine research and testing and development to the laboratory. There's nothing in the ABM Treaty about that, so this would definitely be a change. They described it as a strengthening. In our view, it was an insistence on a limitation that would effectively destroy the ability to do the kind of energetic research leading to our ability to defend ourselves that is possible to do, has great prospects, and we must do.

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Q: Is there a potential, Mr. Secretary --

Q. Mr. Secretary, when did they begin insisting on this amount? Was this right from the beginning or is this something they changed in you this afternoon?

of said one and we discussed them. We discussed all these things on the first day but we didn't cover them thoroughly and, of course, we had a lengthy meal. At the night, last night with our two teams and in the morning, on the basis of what was said on the first day, managed to cover a very good language, particularly in the area of strategic thinking. I don't want to say that this was somehow a lost minute but I think I am talking about this for a long time and we've

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Q Mr. Secretary?

A Mr. Secretary: So, that's where we came down.

Q Mr. Secretary?

A Mr. Secretary, what -- given that the President and Mr. Carter could not reach an agreement here today, what can you reasonably expect to happen in Geneva that they couldn't accomplish here and doesn't this effectively end the chances for meaningful arms agreements in Mr. Reagan's term?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: Well, I hope it doesn't end the chances for agreements, but I can't say for sure about that. What I can say is that our negotiators will be back in Geneva and we will be there knowing all of the ins and outs, as they will, of what was discussed here. We will be there in a constructive spirit and we will see what we can do to advance things further. The purpose of this meeting, you remember, was to try to advance to give instructions to three negotiators and others in other fora, that would move matters along. And while, in the end, we weren't able to wrap all these up, in the course of the discussion many important things were agreed to sort of depended upon other things so that there is a great deal of potential accomplishment still there, but it's not going to try to predict exactly what will happen.

Q Mr. Secretary?

A Mr. Secretary, given the potential accomplishment that you talk about, does the talking in Geneva start from the points where you left off here or does it go back to where it was before this summit took place?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: Well, we're glad to pick up where we left off here. What they will want to do, we'll have to see. But there were a great many important ideas advanced, as you can see from what I told you. Well, as the time unfolds here, give you a complete rundown on all of this, which I can't just do offhand here. But, at any rate, a great deal of progress was made.

Q Mr. Secretary?

A Mr. Secretary, as you know, there's been some varying interpretations of the ABM Treaty. Could you clarify whether you -- they were talking about wanting to adhere to the so-called narrow interpretation of the treaty or the broad interpretation? And what is the administration's position on that narrow or broad question? Are you trying to defend the broad interpretation the way you've always said was legally proper or -- at least in the last few years?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: That's not the issue. The issue was a proposal to change the ABM Treaty -- not to interpret it in any particular way -- but to change it by such a manner that research would be confined to what you could do in a laboratory -- that's a change. Mr. Carter, insofar as our position is concerned, what the President put forward, as he has before, was the notion was that during this period our research would be as permitted in the ABM Treaty. And, of course, we have been discussing this. Ambassador Chapman has been discussing it, but we're perfectly prepared to discuss it in Geneva, and we'll discuss it fully. And there is a very, well developed and, by now, very well documented record of that question. As the issue wasn't an interpretation. It was a proposal to make a change which, in our view -- I want to look the President's view or my view, but I think all of them would agree that it was a change that would have made it

...to have research to defend ourselves.

Q. Now, Secretary, now that you have said mean that we don't expect to have a superpower summit in Washington within the next year, is the Soviet attitude inflexible last year?

SECRETARY SHULTS: I don't say any prospect of it based on, but I've long since learned not to rule anything out.

Q. Mr. Secretary, did you have a feeling as you left this meeting that the Soviet position on this was set in concrete? Or is there any way that it's possible to return to this amendment in any kind of forum to address some of the changes that you had talked about?

SECRETARY SHULTS: Well, we certainly argued about it long and hard and we had -- we came -- I've lost track of the amount of time. I don't even know what time it is now. But at any rate, we convened in Hoffa House. We took time for discussing. We reviewed proposals. We made counter-proposals back and forth to a considerable extent around this issue, so there was a tremendous amount of effort on the last session, which went on for quite some period -- I don't know how long, but we'll know -- But the last session after our last caucus, which really did focus on this issue directly, there was a very long, searching effort and it didn't succeed. So, I don't know what concrete is like, but it seemed fairly firm.

Q. Mr. Secretary, you came into this meeting saying you hoped to elevate the issue of human rights. Did you, or did it get lost in this discussion about SDI and arms control?

SECRETARY SHULTS: The issue of human rights was brought up on a number of occasions and some very significant material was passed to the Soviet Union, which they accepted, that stated not only our views, but, in detail, things about Jewish emigration, the number of people who have signified their desire to leave, lists of people and things of that kind. So all of that was covered. And in the -- what might have been a statement coming out of the meeting dealing with this issue, the subject is explicitly referred to and perhaps at any point there is a prospect of setting up some kind of systematic basis for discussing it. But, of course, that remains to be seen.

Q. Mr. Secretary, are you, in effect, saying that potential progress was made on INF, but that the Soviets are now linking that progress to SDI again?

SECRETARY SHULTS: Well, I wouldn't put it that formally, but certainly as we have gone through these things we saw the potential of a set of genuinely significant agreements -- on INF, on strategic arms, on, potentially, the elimination of all offensive ballistic missiles, on space and defense, and there was a kind of integrated feel to them. And we came up to the end, and we didn't agree so we didn't go back and say, well, now that we have failed to agree, let's see how we can sort this out? We came to the end and the sorting out process we'll have to take up, no doubt, in Geneva.

Q. Mr. Secretary, was that one -- did you have one piece of paper -- that's what you seem to be suggesting -- which listed all these progress areas, but that, when the discussion broke down over the SDI issue, the Soviets would not agree to the individual points in the paper? I'm trying to get a feeling of why everything became interlocked, as Annie said -- the INF, we thought, had been separated out.

SECRETARY SHULTS: I think the best way for me to answer that question is to go back descriptively in the process. In the process, we took up each of these subjects. And the last time in the two working groups, we tried to go from the statements that were made in the openings of the two leaders to explicit language. And we

...in the range of... We were unable to do so... the strong discussion on that today the... I think could be a... around to actually reducing that... given the agreements that were... had been too difficult.

Similarly, in the field of nuclear testing, we talked... our pretty fair measure of agreement on the content of what might be... and my own belief is if we had gone forward we would have been... to work that out. And we had pieces of paper that we were... from on the open defense AMM issue that represented the... nature of the discussion and it was over that wording that finally... in the end -- about however long ago it was, three-quarters of an... hour ago -- the two leaders decided that they just weren't able to... agree. And at that point, not being able to agree, we adjourned. We... didn't, in other words, go back and say, well, now wait a minute --... how much of this and how much of that -- descriptively, these are the... things that went along. And so we pick up and continue to work on... this relationship, as, at least, we certainly intend to do, we will... want to see how much constructive material we can develop out of... these really extraordinary discussions that were had here in... pavlovic.

Q. Mr. Secretary, can you tell us exactly what was the potential agreement that you reached on START?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: Basically to reduce strategic offensive arms in half with references in the agreement numerically to both launchers and warheads. So, I could describe it in more detail, but that's the essence of it.

Q. Mr. Secretary, could you say whether there was any progress made, at all on the issue of verification in regards to nuclear testing? And a second question -- critics will charge undoubtedly that this administration had chosen Star Wars or SDI over arms control. Is that a fair accusation?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: That's a totally misplaced kind of statement because the fact of the matter is that the existence of the strong research program about strategic defense and its undoubted promise has had a great deal to do with bringing these talks to the point that they've gotten to, and I believe that the continued strong work on that program in existence or reductions, if they had taken place, were going on, would be your best insurance policy that they would continue. That is, I think we have to think beyond verification into compliance and what brings about compliance. And, in effect, the promise of strategic defense is the thing that would help deliver on these promises. So that's the way I think of it and perhaps the significance of strategic defense is not lost on either side. And that's what it comes down to.

Q. Mr. Secretary, did the President make any statement to Mr. Gorbachev on the consequences of this outcome of their meeting?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: Well, they both shared their disappointment, and I think they could both see the very positive consequences as people in the United States, people in the Soviet Union and, for that matter, people all over the world might contemplate getting rid of ballistic missiles and, for that matter, getting rid of nuclear weapons. So, there is a great sense of disappointment about at least at this meeting a tremendous amount of... the... didn't quite make it.

...the... between the two men at the

SECRETARY SHULTZ: Well, they were both disappointed, but

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Q. Now, Secretary, can you characterize the INV record that you just appeared to be worked out? Did they -- did the Soviets address the question of the Asian minorities and can you tell us what was planned?

So we were consistent with our friends in Europe and consistent with our friends in Asia. And I think, also, I might say in the discussion across all subjects, there was a vigorous assertion -- in some ways, rather interesting -- a vigorous assertion on both sides of how insistent they were both going to be on adequate verification, which, of course, we welcomed.

Q Mr. Secretary, the ABM Treaty says that each party undertakes to develop tests -- not to develop tests or deploy ABM systems or components -- space-based, land-based, or sea-based. Why did the Soviets want to change that? What prompted them? Was it the American insistence on the broad interpretation or -- during this 10 years? Why did they want to change that?

Q. Did you specifically discuss the continuation of talks at Geneva? and did the Soviets either leave it unclear or indicate to you in any way that they might not return to the table at Geneva?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: As I said in response to an earlier question, I think only a few of the details of what we didn't discuss at the end of the day are being brought to Geneva, or what we are going to do. We need to work out an agreement finally and there won't be a lot of details. I don't think any particular push to go back and recapitulate that way. But I can say what the United States will do. We will have our headquarters in Geneva and we will be ready to work on those important issues.

SECRET

Mr. Secretary --

Q. ... Soviets -- what do we know the Soviets are doing
What can we learn by their stance?

Q. What about NATO?

SECRETARY SHULTZ: There will be people who will brief
on background and I know I've hit these things in a very broad way
necessarily, but we'll be prepared to go into more detail as the
time goes along.

THE PRESS: Thank you.

END

7:59 P.M. (L)

SECRET